Learn Words About a New Subject

Vocabulary Words

condensation
droplet
evaporation
precipitation
water vapor

Word Learning Tip!

Every subject has its special words. These words matter a great deal because they tell about the subject. However, you have probably never seen some of these words before. They are often long and look hard, too. Fortunately, you can often understand these words by examining the big idea or topic that you are reading about. Then think about what part of it each word describes.

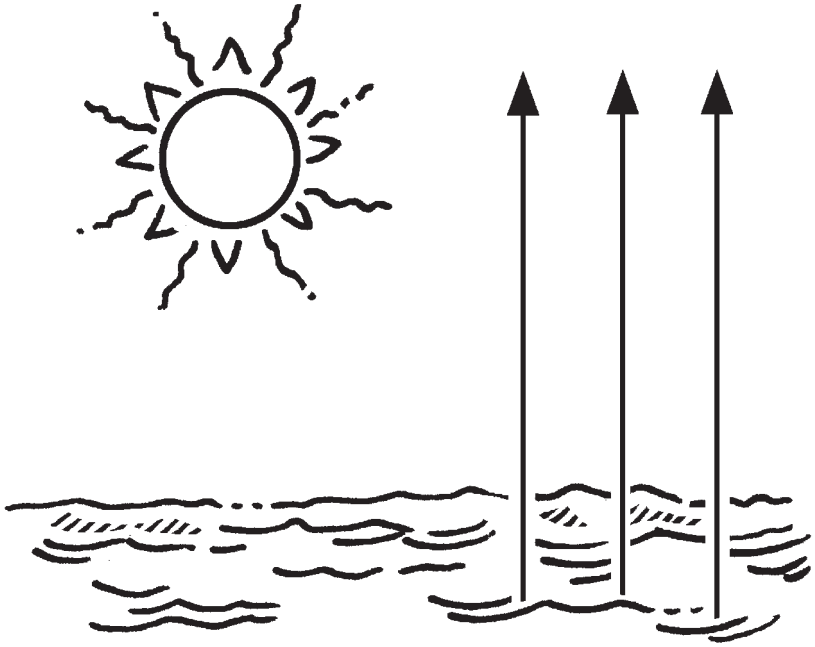
Vocabulary Building Strategy

To learn the meaning of content words that tell about a new subject, make connections between the unknown word and the big idea or subject. The new word will tell something specific about the big idea. Tie together the big idea and the meanings of other content words that you know in the text. This will help you determine the exact meaning of the unknown content words.

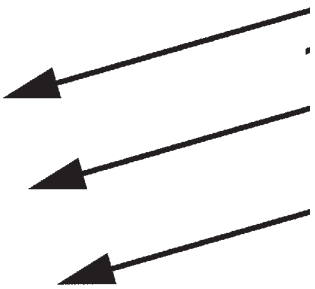
Directions As you study the following diagram of the water cycle, think about how each boldface word is linked to the topic. Ask yourself, "How does this word connect to the big idea of the water cycle?"

The Water Cycle

Heat from the sun causes water to change into a gas called **water vapor**. This process is called **evaporation**.



A **droplet** hits the lake! The water begins the process of **evaporation** again.



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Water vapor changes back to a liquid in the atmosphere. This process is called **condensation**. **Condensation** forms clouds.

A tiny **droplet** of water adds to others to form clouds.



Precipitation falls from clouds filled with water. Much of the **precipitation** soaks the ground.

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Connect Words and Meanings

condensation	droplet	evaporation	precipitation	water vapor

Directions Complete the crossword puzzle below. You may use your dictionary or the glossary to help you.

Across

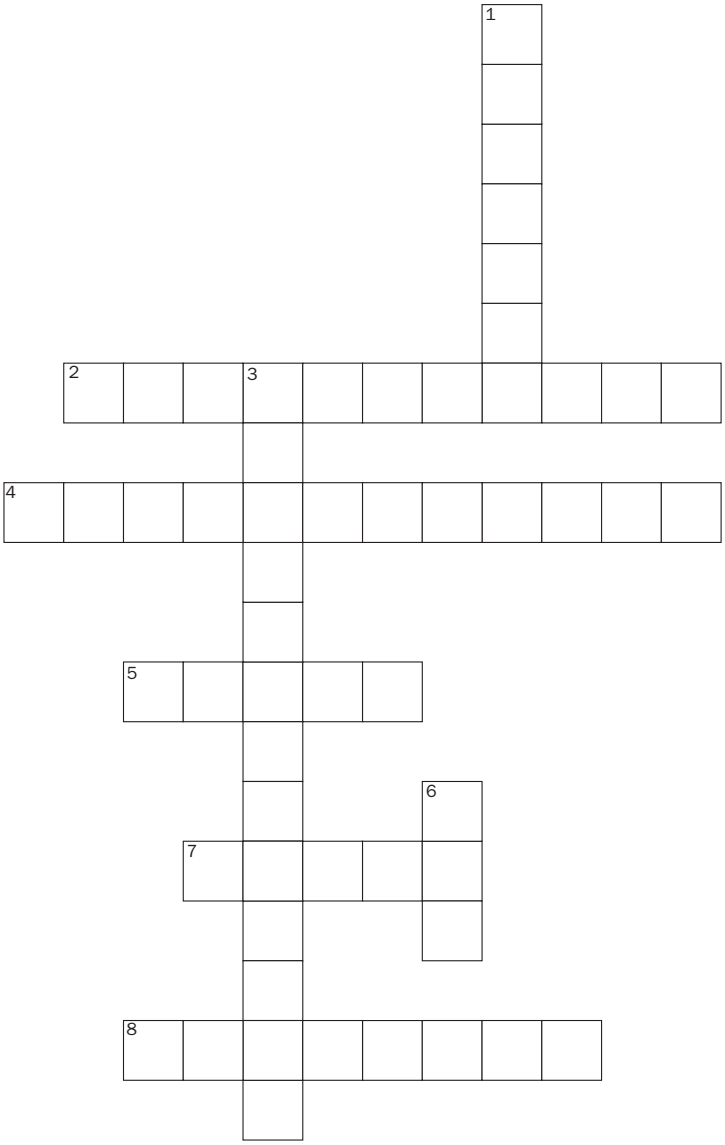
2. the act or process by which a liquid becomes a gas

4. the process or way water vapor becomes a liquid

5. Water _____ is an invisible gas that forms after water evaporates.

7. _____ vapor occurs when liquid water evaporates.

8. Ice crystals or _____ of water may fall to the earth.



Down

1. a tiny drop or quantity of liquid

3. the falling of water from the sky in the form of rain, sleet, or snow

6. After evaporation, your wet sweater would be _____.

Find Related Words When you look at long words, you can often find shorter words or parts of shorter words in them. For example, the word *evaporation* contains the words *vapor* and *evaporate*. These words have related meanings. They also tell about the water cycle. Find the shorter words in *condensation* and *precipitation*. Write them and their meanings in your personal word journal. Then write a sentence using each related word. You may use your dictionary to help you.

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Use Content Words

condensation	droplet	evaporation	precipitation	water vapor

Directions Use the content words to complete the sentences below. Write the words in the blank.

1. In the early morning, you can see tiny _____ (s) of water on flowers. This is called *dew*.
2. Humidity occurs when there is too much _____ in the air, so everything feels moist.
3. If you heat water to 212° F, it will boil. This starts the _____ process.
4. Rain, hail, and sleet are three different forms of _____.
5. Before it rains, water vapor changes to a liquid in a process called _____.
6. If you see dark nimbus clouds in the sky, you can expect _____, or rain.
7. Cirrus clouds are wispy clouds. They contain crystals of ice and tiny _____(s) of water.
8. When there is not enough rain, airplanes may drop seeds in clouds to start the _____ process. The seeds help turn the water vapor into a liquid.
9. If you leave a glass of water on the kitchen counter for several days, each day the amount of water will become less and less because of the process of _____.
10. If you live near a lake or on the sea coast, there is more _____ in the air than if you live in the desert.

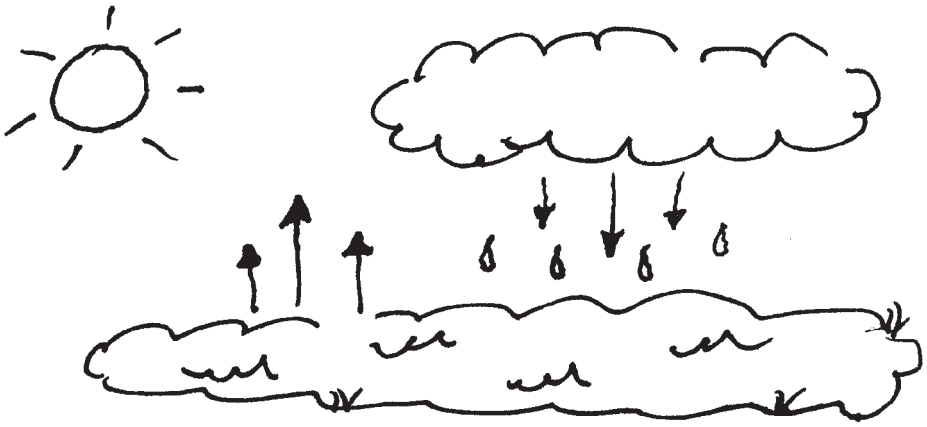
Write an Editorial Most of Earth's surface is water, but 97 percent of that water is salt water. Of the remaining three percent, two-thirds is frozen in the North and South Poles. Therefore, only about one percent of the water on Earth can be used for drinking and growing food. Write an editorial for the school newspaper in which you persuade readers to protect Earth's water from pollution. In your editorial, explain the importance of the water cycle. Use at least three vocabulary words in your editorial and two additional content words that you learned by using the Word Learning Tip and Vocabulary Building Strategy.

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Put Words Into Action

condensation	droplet	evaporation	precipitation	water vapor

Directions Kevin is making an oral presentation about the water cycle. He made this diagram to accompany his talk. Help him complete his talk by writing the correct vocabulary words in the blanks.



Notice the sun shining brightly. It heats up the water in the lake. This begins the process of **(1)**_____. Some of the water evaporates and turns into a gas called **(2)**_____. The arrows show that this invisible gas rises. This gas cools as it goes higher and higher in the sky. It condenses and forms **(3)**_____ of water. During **(4)**_____, the gas or **(5)**_____ is turned back into a liquid.

Clouds are made up of many tiny water **(6)**_____(s) that have attached themselves to small pieces of dust or smoke in the air. When the clouds become too heavy and can't hold any more moisture, **(7)**_____ occurs in the form of rain, sleet, snow, or hail.

Notice the arrows pointing downward. They show **(8)**_____ falling to the ground.

The water then runs down the land back into the lake, where the process of **(9)**_____ starts all over again.

Sometimes the air is very dirty. Smog is the result of **(10)**_____, since water vapor condenses on the dirty particles in the air to form a smoky fog, called smog.

Make a Cartoon Draw a cartoon about the water cycle. Your cartoon can take any form that you wish but must fit on a sheet of unlined 8 1/2" x 11" paper. Use all your vocabulary words and two other words that you learned by reading this page and by using the Word Learning Tip and Vocabulary Building Strategy.

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Review and Extend

condensation	droplet	evaporation	precipitation	water vapor

Bonus Words Below are two more words about the water cycle. Keep in mind that these new words are about the same big idea as the rest of the new words you learned in this lesson.

cumulus clouds	big, puffy clouds that form in warm air on sunny days
dew point	the air temperature at which dew forms

Directions Below are five questions about the vocabulary words and their function in the water cycle. Choose a vocabulary word or bonus word that answers the question. Write it on the blank.

1. I am often called the "fair weather clouds" because I form in warm air on sunny days.

   What am I? _____

2. I am the process by which water changes to a gas called water vapor. I move water from lakes to clouds.

   What am I? _____

3. Farmers like me when I form as rain for their crops. Children like me when I come as snow. Few people like me when I come as icy, cold sleet!

   What am I? _____

4. I am the temperature at which air becomes filled with water and dew forms.

   What am I? _____

5. I form on the outside of a glass of ice water. I form when it rains. I'm a cute little bead of water.

   What am I? _____

Search for New Words About Weather Look through books, science magazines, and on the Internet. Find at least four new words related to the topic of the weather. Write the words and the sentences in which you found them in your personal word journal.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Circle the letter of the correct answer to each statement below.

1. A **droplet** would most likely be the size of a _____.
A. small button **B.** car **C.** cell phone **D.** CD

2. In the water cycle, **condensation** forms _____.
A. heat
B. salt water to fill the oceans
C. clouds
D. lots of rain, snow, and icy sleet

3. **Evaporation** could take place with all of the following BUT _____.
A. lake water **B.** orange juice **C.** milk **D.** fish

4. Farmers like **precipitation** because _____.
A. horses need sunny days
B. their crops need rain
C. the clouds provide shade
D. it removes extra rain and moisture

5. **Water vapor** is best described as _____.
A. a gas **B.** a liquid **C.** clouds **D.** a small pond

Directions Read each item below. Then circle the letter of the vocabulary word that best completes each sentence.

6. The water cycle begins with _____, when heat from the sun causes water to change to a gas.
A. droplet **B.** precipitation **C.** evaporation

7. At the end of the water cycle, _____ falls back to earth as rain or snow.
A. evaporation **B.** droplet **C.** precipitation

8. Water vapor forms into a liquid in clouds through a process called _____
A. precipitation **B.** condensation **C.** droplet

9. Rain can fall lightly in small _____(s) or in a torrent like a waterfall!
A. droplet **B.** evaporation **C.** condensation

10. More and more _____ condenses to form bigger and bigger clouds.
A. evaporation **B.** water vapor **C.** precipitation

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